RAAHIL MADHOK

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RESEARCH AREAS

Environmental Economics, Development Economics

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2025–Present	Assistant Professor of Applied Economics, University of Minnesota
2023–2024	President's Postdoctoral Fellow, University of Minnesota

AFFILIATIONS

2026–Present	Faculty Affiliate, Interdisciplinary Center for Global Change
2026–Present	Graduate Faculty, Natural Resource Sciences and Management
2025–Present	Faculty Member, Minnesota Population Center
2025–Present	Faculty Affiliate, NatCap TEEMS
2025–Present	Steering Committee, Center for International Food and Agricultural Policy

EDUCATION

2023	Ph.D., Food and Resource Economics, University of British Columbia *Thesis: Three Essays in Environmental and Development Economics*
2015	M.A., Economics, University of British Columbia
2012	B.A., Economics, Environmental Studies, McGill University

PUBLICATIONS

1. "Cash Crops and the Development-Environment Tradeoff: Evidence from Benin."
(with Zhenong Jin and Leikun Yin). **Land Economics, 2026**
2. "Infrastructure, Institutions, and the Conservation of Biodiversity in India."
Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists, 2025
3. "Ruling The Roost: Avian Species Reclaim Urban Habitat During India's COVID-19 Lockdown
(with Sumeet Gulati)". **Biological Conservation, 2022**
4. "Saving the world from your couch: The heterogeneous medium-run benefits of COVID-19 lockdowns on air pollution (with J.P. Bonardi, Q. Gallea, D. Kalanoski, R. Lalive, F. Noack, D. Rohner, and T. Sonno)"
Environmental Research Letters, 2021

WORKING PAPERS

1. "Urban Growth and the Spatial Reorganization of Agriculture."
(with Frederik Noack, Mushfiq Mobarak, and Olivier Deschenes).
Revision Requested, **American Economic Journal: Economic Policy**
2. "Does Women's Autonomy Improve Forest Restoration? Experimental Evidence from the Himalayas"
(with P. Choksi, E. Coleman, H. Fischer, F. Fleischman, M. Khanyari, P. Rana, E. Sills).
Accepted (pre-results review), **Journal of Development Economics**
3. "Off-Target Impacts of Targeted Policy: Evidence from the World's Largest Anti-Narcotics Intervention."
(with Tatiana Zarate-Barrera). **Submitted.**

4. "Ethnic Favouritism in Environmental Disaster Payouts."
(with Sumeet Gulati and Pushpendra Rana). **Submitted.**

5. "Indigenous Land Rights and Firm Behavior." (with Sabyasachi Das). **Submitted.**

SELECTED RESEARCH IN PROGRESS (* graduate student co-authors)

1. "How do Rural Economies Adjust when Labor Emigrates? Seventy-Five Years Since Lewis (1954)."
(with Mushfiq Mobarak)

2. "Willingness to Pay for Biodiversity in a Developing Country: Evidence from Citizen Science."
(with Matt Braaksma*, Jovin Lasway*, and Ryan Mcway*)

3. "Gross Ecosystem Product." (with NatCap TEEMS)

4. "Eradicating Illicit Coca with Aerial Glyphosate Spraying Causes Persistent Biodiversity Loss."
(with Colleen Miller and Tatiana Zarate-Barrera)

POLICY WRITING

1. "How internal migration is reshaping rural India." *VoxDev (2025)*

2. "Internal migration and the spatial reorganisation of agriculture." *Ideas4India (2025)*

3. "Can inclusive institutions mitigate the development-biodiversity tradeoff?" *VoxDev (2025)*

4. "Pollution reductions during lockdown can teach us how to build a sustainable economy." *VoxEU (2021)*

5. "Multi-media Impacts of Cannabis Production in Metro Vancouver." *MetroVancouver Policy Report (2019).*

6. "Water Pollution and Public Health in India: The Potential for a Market-Based Approach." (with Michael Greenstone, Rohini Pande, and Hardik Shah). *Health and South Asia Digital Handbook (2013).*

SELECTED GRANTS AND AWARDS

2026	Grant-in-Aid Award ($50,000)
2024	Postdoctoral Career Development Award
2019-2023	SSHRC Joseph-Armand Bombardier Doctoral Fellowship
2020	Nehru Humanitarian Award in Indian Studies

PRESENTATIONS/SEMINARS (* Scheduled)

2026	University of Utah, Ashoka University, Indian Statistical Institute (Delhi), The Nature Conservancy, University of Saskatchewan*, Firms, Trade & Development Workshop*
2025	NEUDC, UCSB Occasional Workshop, LEEP Institute (University of Exeter Econ Department), Queensland University of Technology (Econ Department), Australasian Development Economics Workshop, Australasian Agricultural and Resource Economics Society, AERE Summer Conference, Big Sky Workshop (Montana State), NatCap TEEMS
2024	PPFP Symposium, WEAI, AERE, Heartland Workshop (UIUC), Macalester College, University of Minnesota, NatCap TEEMS
2023	World Bank, UC San Diego (21CIC Seminar), CREEA, Keio University (Japan), University of Ottawa, UW-Madison, University of Minnesota (Applied Economics), Simon Fraser University, EPA NCEE, Mathematica, UCSB Occasional Workshop
2022	NBER Summer Institute (Environment & Energy Economics), UBC Vancouver School of Economics, PacDev, OSWEET, Columbia IPWSD Workshop, WEAI, AERE, CREEA
2021	Camp Resources, AERE, CREEA (Best Paper Prize), Columbia IPWSD Workshop

TEACHING

APEC 3001	Intermediate Microeconomics (Undergraduate, Fall 2025)
APEC 8604	Environmental and Development Economics (PhD Level, Fall 2024, Syllabus)
FRE 460	Economics of Food Consumption (Undergraduate, Winter 2022, Syllabus)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2019	Consultant, Metro Vancouver, Environmental Regulation & Enforcement
2015 - 2016	Pre-Doctoral Fellow to Rohini Pande, Harvard Kennedy School
2012 - 2014	Research Assistant to Michael Greenstone, Rohini Pande, Nick Ryan, and Anant Sudarshan, J-PAL South Asia

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee: *Review of Economics and Statistics, Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists, Journal of Environmental Economics and Management, American Journal of Agricultural Economics, Land Economics, Resource and Energy Economics, Economic Modelling, Environment and Development Economics, Agricultural Economics, Environmental Research Letters, Global Ecology and Conservation*

Abstract Reviewer: Midwestern International Economic Development Conference, AAEA Summer Conference, AERE Summer Conference, AERE@SEA

Other Service: Mentor, Association for Mentoring and Inclusion in Economics; 2024 AERE Scholar

DEPARTMENTAL SERVICE

2026	Placement Committee, Co-organizer of Joint Environmental Economics & Policy Seminar
2025	Placement Committee, 2nd-year paper advisor, DEI Committee

SKILLS

Software: Stata, R, Python, GIS

Languages: English (Native), Hindi (intermediate), Spanish (intermediate)

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: Canada, USA Hobbies: hiking, hip hop, improv comedy